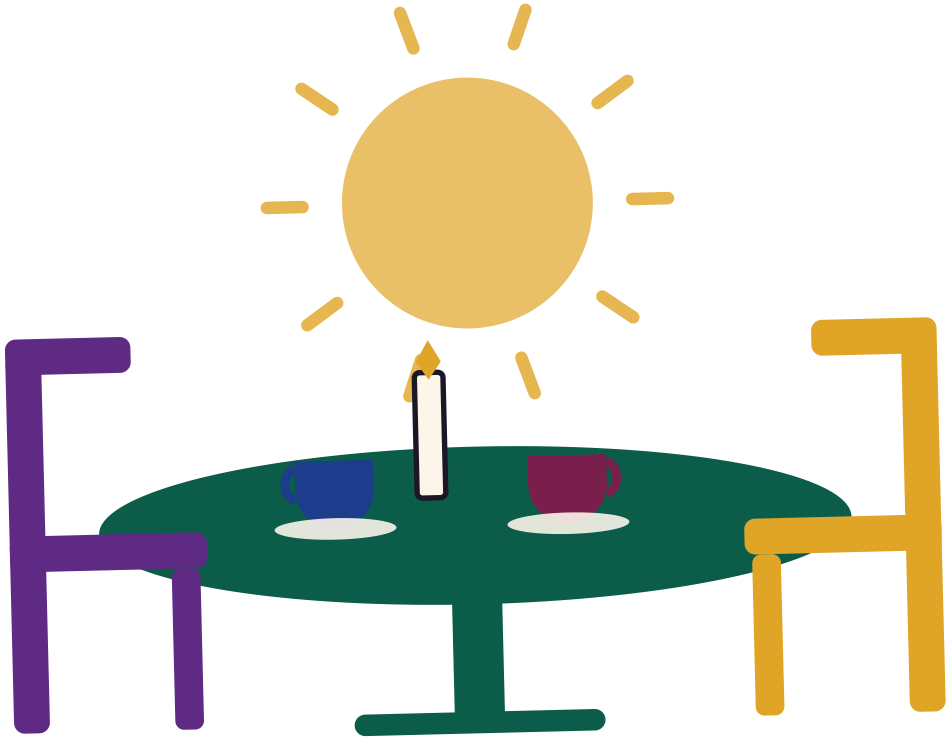
FREE GUIDE · CHAOTIC SUNSHINE · PULL UP A CHAIR

The Table Talks *Guide.*

QUESTIONS AND HABITS FOR FRIENDSHIPS THAT GO DEEP

Skip the small talk.
Jump in the deep end.



"As iron sharpens iron, so one person sharpens another."
PROVERBS 27:17 · NIV

Chaotic Sunshine

WELCOME

hi, I'm Amy.

I've had plenty of contacts and no one to call at 10 p.m. I've sat in a full church and felt completely alone. What changed things for me was a few women around a table who were willing to skip the small talk and go deep.

This guide is how we do that at Table Talks. It borrows the best habits of people who study connection for a living, then adds what matters most to us: Scripture, prayer and a seat for everyone.

Inside

- **Three habits of great connectors**: Spark, Steady and See
- **Swap the script**: better questions than "How are you?"
- **How a Table Talk flows**, plus the table rules
- **The Question Ladder**: 20 questions from light to sacred
- **Nine Table Talk topics** with Scripture
- **Words for tender moments**
- **Host checklist** and follow-up texts
- **Cut-out question cards**

Loved by the Father. Led by the Shepherd.
Pull up a chair. You belong here.

THE THREE HABITS

How great connectors do it

Three habits, drawn from people who study connection, adapted for our table.

Spark

INSPIRED BY VANESSA VAN EDWARDS

Start where people light up.

- Swap autopilot questions for ones that invite a story.
- Ask about highlights, hopes and what someone is into lately.
- Remember a detail and bring it back later: “You mentioned your sister’s surgery. How is she?”

Steady

INSPIRED BY JEFFERSON FISHER

Stay calm, clear and kind.

- Take one breath before you answer. The pause is where kindness lives.
- Say the goal out loud: “I just want to understand.”
- Reflect back what you heard: “What I’m hearing is... Did I get that right?”

See

INSPIRED BY DAVID BROOKS

Be an illuminator.

- Get curious about the person behind the answer. Curiosity beats judgment.
- Ask bigger questions about joy, fear, meaning and story.
- Stay with people in hard things. Presence matters more than fixing.

SPARK

Swap the script

Autopilot questions get autopilot answers. Try the swap and watch the conversation open up.

INSTEAD OF	TRY
~~How are you?~~	***What's been the highlight of your week?***
~~What do you do?~~	***What are you working on that excites you lately?***
~~Where are you from?~~	***What place feels most like home to you?***
~~How was your weekend?~~	***What was the best part of your weekend?***
~~Are you busy?~~	***What's filling your days right now, and how are you really doing with it?***
~~How's church?~~	***Where have you noticed God lately?***

Follow-up magic

- "What was that like?"
- "Tell me more about that."
- "How did you get through it?"
- "What did that teach you?"

one good follow-up beats ten clever questions.

HOW IT WORKS

How a Table Talk flows

About 65 minutes, 6 to 12 women, around a real table or on a video call.

10 min	**Spark round** Everyone answers one light question. Keep it quick and fun.
30 min	**The deep question** One question from the topic. Go around, anyone can pass, listen fully.
10 min	**Scripture** Read the verse out loud. Ask: what stands out to you?
10 min	**Pray** Share one request each. Pray for the woman on your right.
5 min	**Check-out** One word for how you're leaving tonight.

The table rules

- What's said at the table stays at the table.
- Listen to understand.
- No fixing unless someone asks.
- Anyone can pass. Always.
- Phones face down.
- Share your own story, not someone else's.

THE QUESTION LADDER

Climb one rung at a time

Start low, go deeper as trust grows. Every rung is optional.

1 Sparks light and fun

- What's been the highlight of your week?
- What are you looking forward to this month?
- What's something you're into lately?
- What small thing made you smile recently?
- What's the best thing you've read or watched this year?

2 Stories the life behind the answer

- Tell me about a place that shaped you.
- Who was a teacher or mentor who saw something in you?
- What did Sundays look like when you were growing up?
- What's a turning point in your life?
- What's something you've changed your mind about?

3 Soul what's really going on

- What are you carrying right now?
- What's giving you life lately, and what's draining it?
- Where do you feel most like yourself?
- What do you wish more people knew about you?
- What is this season of life teaching you?

4 Sacred faith and the deep end

- What's a prayer you've carried the longest?
- When did you last feel close to God?
- What are you afraid to want?
- Who knew you at your worst and stayed?
- What would it look like to stop performing?

NINE TABLE TALKS

Topics for your table

One topic per gathering. Read the verse together before the deep question.

01 Beloved, Really

SPARK	What's something about you that you're quietly proud of?
DEEP END	When have you felt most loved by God, and when have you doubted it?
SCRIPTURE	1 John 3:1 (NIV)
TRY THIS	Begin every prayer this week with "Father."

02 Called by Name

SPARK	Is there a story behind your name?
DEEP END	What labels have you carried that God never gave you?
SCRIPTURE	Isaiah 43:1 (NIV)
TRY THIS	Write one name God gives you on a card.

03 The God Who Sees

SPARK	Who is someone who really notices people?
DEEP END	Where do you feel unseen right now?
SCRIPTURE	Genesis 16:13 (NIV)
TRY THIS	Text one person this week: "I see you."

04 Set in Families

SPARK	What did friendship look like for you at age 10?
DEEP END	When have you felt most alone, and who showed up?
SCRIPTURE	Psalm 68:6 (NIV)
TRY THIS	Invite one woman to something small.

05 *Longing*

SPARK	What's a dream you had as a kid?
DEEP END	What are you hoping for that hasn't happened yet?
SCRIPTURE	Proverbs 13:12 (NIV)
TRY THIS	Tell God the longing out loud, in plain words.

06 *Rest*

SPARK	What does a perfect lazy day look like for you?
DEEP END	What makes rest hard for you?
SCRIPTURE	Matthew 11:28 (NIV)
TRY THIS	Schedule one hour of rest and guard it.

07 *Two Are Better*

SPARK	Who is a friend who changed your life?
DEEP END	What makes it hard for you to let people in?
SCRIPTURE	Ecclesiastes 4:9-10 (NIV)
TRY THIS	Reach out to someone you've lost touch with.

08 *Brave*

SPARK	What's the bravest thing you've ever done?
DEEP END	What would you do if you weren't afraid?
SCRIPTURE	Joshua 1:9 (NIV)
TRY THIS	Take one small brave step this week.

09 *Joy, Actually*

SPARK	What's a simple joy you never get tired of?
DEEP END	Where have you found joy in a hard season?
SCRIPTURE	Zephaniah 3:17 (NIV)
TRY THIS	Do one thing just for delight.

STEADY

Words for tender moments

Take a breath first. Then try one of these.

When someone cries

"Take your time. We're not going anywhere." Slide the tissues over and let the quiet be okay.

When the conversation stalls

"Can I go first?" Share a short, honest answer of your own.

When one person talks a lot

"I love this. Let's hear from someone who hasn't shared yet."

When you disagree

"Help me understand how you got there." Stay curious before you respond.

When something heavy is shared

"Thank you for trusting us. Can we pray for that right now?"

When you're not sure what she needs

"Do you want us to listen, or help you think it through?"

When you say the wrong thing

"That came out wrong. Can I try again?"

When someone needs more than a group

Gently share a trusted pastor, counselor or local resource, and check in privately.

FOR HOSTS

Host checklist

- [ ] Invite 6 to 12 women (a real table or a video call).
- [ ] Send the topic and verse a day ahead.
- [ ] Set the space: name cards, a candle, something to nibble.
- [ ] Start on time and end on time. Trust grows when time is honored.
- [ ] Phones face down, including yours.
- [ ] Go first on the deep question, briefly and honestly.
- [ ] Close in prayer.
- [ ] Send a follow-up text the next day.

Follow-up texts to steal

"Still thinking about what you shared last night. Praying for you today."

"You mentioned the interview on Thursday. How did it go?"

"So glad you were at the table. Same time next month?"

the text the next day is where friendship really starts.

CUT ALONG THE DASHES

Question cards

What's been the highlight of your week?

chaotic sunshine TABLE TALKS

What place feels most like home to you?

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Who saw something in you before you did?

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What are you carrying right now?

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Where do you feel most like yourself?

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What is this season teaching you?

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What's a prayer you've carried the longest?

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When did you last feel close to God?

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What are you afraid to want?

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Who knew you at your worst and stayed?

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What would it look like to stop performing?

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What's a simple joy you never get tired of?

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NEVER EAT ALONE

Want a table to sit at?

Join a Table Talk: a small group of women who go deep, pray for real and actually text back. Get on the waitlist and the Sunshine Mail at **chaoticsunshine.com**

follow along @chaoticsunshinetable

CHAOTIC *sunshine*

Habits inspired by the work of Vanessa Van Edwards, Jefferson Fisher and David Brooks. Scripture quotations from the NIV.
Free to print and share.

LOVED THIS? THERE'S MORE WHERE IT CAME FROM

One Sunday a month.

Sunshine Mail is a free monthly letter from Amy Grace: a Bible passage, an honest reflection, and something small to carry into your day.

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